

Delegation Decision Matrix

Protect your Three Things by delegating everything else

Task to Analyze:

Task name:

Current owner:

Time required:

1 Can this task be **ELIMINATED** entirely?

✓ YES

This task exists out of habit, not necessity

ELIMINATE IT

✗ NO

Task is genuinely necessary

GO TO Q2 →



2 Can this task be **AUTOMATED** with technology?

✓ YES

Repetitive, rule-based, or data-driven task

AUTOMATE IT

✗ NO

Requires human judgment

GO TO Q3 →



3

Can this task be DELEGATED to someone else?

✓ YES

Someone else could do this with brief training

DELEGATE IT

✗ NO

Requires your specific expertise

GO TO Q4 →



4

Can this task be BATCHED with similar tasks?

✓ YES

Process multiple similar tasks together efficiently

BATCH IT

✗ NO

Unique task requiring individual attention and your expertise

THIS IS A THREE THINGS CANDIDATE ✓



Decision Record

ELIMINATE (Q1=Yes)

AUTOMATE (Q2=Yes)

DELEGATE (Q3=Yes)

BATCH (Q4=Yes)



My Three Things (All Q's = NO)

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

How to Use This Matrix

Step 1: List all tasks competing for your attention

Step 2: Run each task through the 4 questions in order

Step 3: Take action based on first "Yes" answer:

- Q1=Yes → Eliminate (stop doing it)
- Q2=Yes → Automate (set up system/tool)
- Q3=Yes → Delegate (assign to team member)
- Q4=Yes → Batch (schedule specific time block)
- All No → Transformational work = Your Three Things

Step 4: Protect your Three Things ruthlessly - everything else has been handled

Examples by Category

ELIMINATE:

- Meetings without clear purpose
- Reports nobody reads
- "FYI" email chains
- Redundant approval steps

DELEGATE:

- Routine customer support
- Meeting notes/summaries
- Research compilation
- First-draft writing

AUTOMATE:

- Social media posting
- Report generation
- Email filtering/labeling
- Data entry tasks

BATCH:

- Email responses (2× daily)
- Admin tasks (Friday PM)
- Quick decisions (Monday AM)
- Expense approvals (weekly)

From the **Three Things Productivity System** | Signal/Noise

If it's not transformational, eliminate → automate → delegate → batch. In that order.